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Computer Science Module Choice Opinions For 2023-24

THIS DOCUMENT IS OUT OF DATE - THE MOST RECENT VERSION IS HERE:
Module Choice Opinions For 2024-25

What is this?

This document is a place for people to comment on modules running next year, so younger students can get advice from older students about what modules will suit you best. Think of it as a mini-Wikipedia for modules next year, but opinions as well as facts. Feel free to put whatever you want below, and also edit other pieces of advice to neaten things up. If you don't agree - don't just delete. Comment underneath saying you disagree or explain why.

Disclaimer: This is just crowdsourced so take the information with a pinch of salt; look at the department's actual comms and website about stuff for more information.

Links!

- Module Choice Opinions 2022-23
- Full List of Programmes (Select your year to see the options you have!)
- CSS Discord (Feel free to ask anyone questions about the modules here!)

Key

Code & Link	Module Titles	Semester 1 Credits	Semester 2 Credits
• Opinions • Note, some modules have been split into 2. In both cases, both new modules are in the same semester, written as 20/20.			

Compulsory Modules

06-26581	BSc Computer Science Project	20	20

- Cry
- Cry more
- Pick an idea that you have genuine interest in. You want to still be interested in it in many months time
- Pick an idea and stick with it. If you're someone who gets anxious like me you might be tempted to keep making drastic changes. A bad project done well is much better than a good project barely done (at the end of the day it is your project, don't let inspector comments and such impact where you are going too much)
- You should write down every step you take (even the stupid embarrassing stuff you don't want to demonstrate). Just keep a big document and every time you do something, put it in the doc. You'll thank yourself later when it comes to summarising your process
- Picking a supervisor you actually like makes the whole experience soo much better.
- Based on various people's experience, supervisor choice is **really** important. Some people have spoken to their supervisor literally a handful of times, others have spoken to them every week without fail. If you think you're going to need to bounce ideas off your supervisor a lot, make sure to have a chat with the supervisor you're thinking of before you pick to get an idea of their management style.
- Don't feel too anxious if you haven't got much done before the first inspection, this is time for them to give you advice. However, make sure you don't leave everything until semester two.
- Also, definitely take on board what your supervisor suggests if you can, since they'll be one of the markers.
- If you are struggling for ideas, go through the list of supervisors and look at their websites / what they say in the doc - they often have project ideas there, or list their areas of interest which they are often able to suggest projects for.
- If you want to have a (significantly) better chance at being allocated a specific supervisor, chat to them over the summer! E-mail them a couple of times, setup a call, whatever, and they're very likely to put you down as a preference (they put down student preferences in the same way we put down supervisor preferences) which makes your allocation to them much more likely.
- Project inspectors are randomly allocated and can be hit or, in my case, miss. This can be alleviated by picking a good supervisor and then you can utilise them to guide your project and try to include the things your inspector wants without focussing on that too much.
    - I can second this, making sure you have a good supervisor makes having a bad inspector much less terrible.

- Don't aim to finish work for the deadlines. Be ahead of the deadlines. Don't be coding the majority of your project a week before the demo (like me).

06-26587	**MSc Computer Science Project**	**20**	**40**
● Basically the same but you had to make a video for the demo too?			

Optional Modules

06-35309	**Advanced Functional Programming**	-	**20**
	Advanced Functional Programming (Extended)		

- Martín is a chad 😎
  - Genuinely the best taught module this year, difficulty aside
- I wish they'd taken more time to talk about Agda, and the differences between it and Haskell. There are a lot of tricks that we were only taught after the first practice test that we didn't know.
  - I don't particularly agree with this, I found that all the tricks I needed were already given before the practise test and that I could do well because of that, points were reiterated after the practise but it wasn't anything new beyond more details on constructors
- Emacs is a pain to learn, coming from someone using VSCode for everything.
  - The VSCode Agda extension is pretty bad, it didn't let me use brackets, and half of the commands were broken.
  - I'd recommend installing Agda on your own machine, emacs via ssh is much worse than emacs on its own.
- You'll feel really confused about a lot of things, and then maybe it'll start to click.
- Not completely horrible if you were comfortable with Functional in 2nd year, and works quite well with the first half of PLPDI.
- If you enjoyed the Functional Programming module, do this! A bit less conventional programming, more to do with proofs, but Agda makes that less daunting than it sounds - also Emacs seems very daunting at first, but it's a breeze once you get used to it
  - This is definitely a proofs module more than a functional programming module, but if you liked the paradigms in 2nd year (recursive proofs, etc), it's really interesting.
- Agda is a double edged sword - it's so similar to haskell it's gonna trip you up, but the best part of this module is the fact that Agda does a lot of stuff for you, so you spend less time doing "Agda" and more time doing proofs (if you learn Agda that is)
- If you loved Logic, you'll love this. It is the same kind of proofs but now the computer helps you keep track of everything
- Remember
  - C-u C-u C-c C-,
  - C-c C-c
  - C-c C-r
  - C-c C-a
  - And that's 90% of the work handled for you by Agda being clever
  - Plus C-u C-u C-c C-. and C-c C-s
- How the first few weeks felt

06-35309	**Advanced Functional Programming** **Advanced Functional Programming (Extended)**	-	**20**

- Lecture: Hmm, some interesting content but I'm not sure I really get it
- Lab: I just keep pressing buttons and it just keeps working
  - Honestly the labs are barely proofs, just following patterns of key commands to get Agda to solve them for you
  - (With a little bit of logical reasoning sprinkled on top for the trickier stuff)

- Propositions = Types is honestly the coolest thing, once it clicks it's magic
- Proofs = Programs is cool too
- Agda feels very different to Haskell. In Haskell I found you were thinking how you could implement some algorithm in a recursive way. In Agda you're simply letting the language tell you what to do in a proof, you provide a bit of information and it tells you the next step
- Great module, theory/lecture content can be challenging for the first two weeks or so but everything is very well organised and there's lots of support. Martin's a good lecturer and Eric's even better. Agda is also super satisfying when you do what it wants you to.
- Favourite module this year, agda/emacs may take a bit of getting used to but staff are great. Assessment in 2 assessed labs 1 hr 50 each, 50% with a practice test 2 wks before which was really useful and basically followed the same format. Confusion is inevitable at the start but it gets better!
- Test 1 was well made, Test 2 was **much** harder, very unfair imo
  - Yeah this was ass fr fr (you should still take the module tho it's really cool)
    - Get 100% on Test 1 and don't even sit Test 2 lol
    - *Gets correct lines of code* - "we aren't convinced that you understood the question enough, even though some of it is right, therefore 0 marks" 😎

06-30209 06-38963	**Advanced Networking** **Advanced Networking (Extended)**	**20/20**	**-/-**

06-30209 06-38963	**Advanced Networking** **Advanced Networking (Extended)**	**20/20**	**-/-**

- Try not to let his introduction lecture put you off him, he's just a failed comedian.
- kinda based tbh, really good approach to just "here's what you need to know"
- Essentially min-maxed teaching - he makes it very clear what content to revise for the exam
    - Matt front loaded his content with what was important and made this very clear to us, guiding us on the sections that were good to know but less important for the exam
    - Most of his part of the exam was either exactly something he had shown before or just slightly different
- I remember him asking us to give him feedback whenever we had to because he didn't want us to think it's a bad module lmao
- "I've been told I can't talk about Sex, Religion, or Politics" followed by a presentation that definitely has nothing to do with those things
- Seems it's an unpopular opinion but I really didn't like this part of the module. Likely due to the fact I had covid for the first two weeks and couldn't go to the lectures (which weren't recorded) meaning I missed out on the part where he told us we didn't need to cover large parts of the provided material (and there was *a lot*). Also, content didn't feel like it would actually be that useful in the 'real world'. Matt was very friendly and eager to help if you emailed him but the slides were full of mistakes and randomly missed out important parts of proofs from the 'optional further reading' from which they were copied almost verbatim. He also has a nasty habit of not explaining any of the challenging content every week and just saying 'you'll need to spend some time with this' and skipping over the slides, leaving you to try to make sense of it yourself. Again, tbf to him he told me he only got a few days notice that he would be teaching in this module before it started but he did have about seven weeks from the start of the module until he actually started teaching us. Actual assessed content was easy though. TL;DR: don't get covid, go to the lectures
- I would kind of disagree with the above, since every week there was one ~1 hour pre recorded video released for the content, where he would always clearly say that everything you needed to know was in the video. So this was always an option if you prefer pre recorded videos as opposed to in person lectures. Also I think he did record the in person lectures, just never put them up since the pre recorded videos were always there. They were available on request
    - This is true but these videos were pretty superficial and contained far more content than I was later told was actually required. However, it does appear that this information was made available much earlier so this is all just my experience and doesn't seem to be a reason not to pick this module next year.

06-30209 06-38963	**Advanced Networking** **Advanced Networking (Extended)**	**20/20**	**-/-**

- The content can be hard to wrap your head around but I don't think there's a better person to teach it besides Matt. He's always very clear on what you will need for the exams.
- His part of the exam is difficult if your memory is poor. However, even remembering some key terms got you a few marks.
- I disagree with people saying his part was a memory game. The algorithms take a good sit down to understand but once you can do that then you can also appreciate the complexities and why it is what it is. Yeah there are some things that you do need to memorise, such as the properties of the algorithms (safety and liveness), but they're similar for each algorithm with minor differences. Again, if you spend a few hours revising and appreciating what is different and why then it becomes less of a memory game than you'd initially think. Matt is also incredibly responsive to emails and very helpful if you ask the right questions (he even replied to my email the night of the painfully boring England vs USA world cup match).
    - +1

06-35308	**Algorithms and Complexity** **Algorithms and Complexity (Extended)**	**-**	**20**

- This has a midterm that's quite challenging for 30% of the module; you really have to be on top of work to really "get" it
- In my opinion, midterm isn't too bad as long as you have been going to lectures and attempting the weekly exercises. You have a whole week to do it so if there's questions you aren't up to date on or clear on you easily have time to go back through lectures and practice.
- Weekly assignments for 2% per week that are pretty easy and good for keeping up with the module
- Really neat module, fun to learn, the weekly problem sheets really help and don't add too much on the workload so they are nice
- If you are interested in complexity theory and algorithmic paradigms/algorithms, this is a good module
- Very interesting module, algorithms are simple to understand if you go to the lectures but some of the content can be a little ambiguous at times so go through it yourself as well

06-30211	**Computer-Aided Verification** **Computer-Aided Verification (Extended)**	**20**	**-**

- I found the labs and all to be quite confusing for this, I wasn't really sure what we were meant to be doing half the time.
- The lecture notes they gave us were pretty good at covering all the content though.
- Let's start with the facts about this module: 20% worth of assignments, 80% worth exam. We'd have one lab per week led by a TA, and 2 hours in total of lectures.
- The assignments, with the exception of one, were based on the labs, with one being based on the lectures.
- The labs were next to useless (!), with the TA seemingly struggling at times (at least in my opinion +1). One lecturer would be present, but he wouldn't partake in the labs. I'm not sure why he was present, but I won't question it.
- The labs were also in UG04 (the computer suite), so there were people in there doing their own work at the same time as the lab and they were quite loud so it was hard to hear the TA.
- The things we were shown in the labs were very very basic, while the assignments were complex. We had to work with SPIN, with the used language being Promela.
- It felt very overwhelming at times, with the only resource online for SPIN (and Promela) having been last updated back in 2012. I could barely understand what was going on, and the lack of discussion online about these 2 things did not help at all.
- So, if you're already familiar with SPIN and Promela, you should be fine. However, if you aren't (just like me), you may struggle quite a bit with this. And by a bit, I mean A LOT.
- The one assignment that was based off the lectures seemed alright, until it came to the marking. Just make sure you understand fairly well the content in the lectures.
- However, one of the funniest things that happened was the fact that the first assignment was quite literally handwritten. I do not wish to criticise the handwriting, but it was barely legible, and it made me think "Seriously? That's what I'm paying 9k per year for?". I think the lecturers did listen to the feedback they've gotten from this incident and haven't released a handwritten assignment again.
- I must say, Sonia's lectures were lovely - her lecture notes went perfectly well with some lofi music in the background, and they were very cohesive. +1.
- In general, the lectures were... fine. Okay. But it did not help me understand what the point of this module was.I still have no idea why I should apply the knowledge gained from this.
- The exam was surprisingly alright. Even so, I would not recommend this module to anyone unless they made some changes to the way the assignments and labs work.
- I feel like we should've been shown some demos as to how to actually use SPIN and program in Promela, and the labs should've gone more in depth about the content we were shown and expected to do in the assignments. The lectures should've shown us real-life situations where we could apply all of this.

06-30211	**Computer-Aided Verification** **Computer-Aided Verification (Extended)**	**20**	**-**

- But yeah, TLDR; This module made me so upset I wouldn't wish this on anyone. (To give you an idea how upset it's made me, I've been eagerly waiting for this document to open up since the 1st semester just to talk about how bad it is).
- As above comment, just don't pick this, the trauma is just too much
- Agreed, this module was poopity poop.

- To provide a different perspective from the above, I quite enjoyed this module. Whilst lectures were confusing at times and some of the lectures were a bit rushed at the end as they had tried to fit too much into one lecture, I found the notes really useful and they contained enough detail that even if I hadn't got something in the lecture I could figure it out from the notes.
  In addition, I found that the module didn't demand that much time compared to some other modules, and the assignments could generally be done in a day or two.
  I agree that the labs themselves were pretty bare bones and not very useful, if you put in just a couple of extra hours to go through the basics in the official documentation alongside the labs and play around with it a bit, it was actually quite enjoyable and cool to put into practice the theory from the lectures a bit. I found the lab-based assignments to be fine having done this - it wasn't spoonfed and you did have to work some of it out yourself and you might expect them to have taught you stuff in the lab they didn't, but I at least enjoyed the problem solving of figuring it out and experimenting with it.
  The first few weeks I was a bit confused about the purpose of the module, but by the end I really appreciated how it all fit together - every single lecture ended up being part of one big story, going through the entire process of software verification starting with modelling in different ways, generating constraints, how this works theoretically and then how this is practically translated into a tractable problem and solved. I do think they could have done a better job at explaining when this is done and why, but also you can just google 'model checking software verification'. It is quite niche, but is used in practice for modelling systems and verifying properties about them.
- Quite a logic-heavy module

06-30213	**Computer Vision and Imaging** **Computer Vision and Imaging (Extended)**	**-**	**20**

- Very interesting, and a good mix of practical + theory
- Weekly (unassessed) labs where you try out features that you have learned about in the lectures
- I like the fact that we're given things to do, so we don't have just theory.
- Very interesting module which is taught well, covers a range of computer vision

06-30213	**Computer Vision and Imaging** **Computer Vision and Imaging (Extended)**	-	20

approaches and is nicely paced. The lab write ups are in the style of the 50% coursework submission and you are given feedback on them, so you have lots to go off of when doing the final coursework piece.

- Uncle Hamid teaches really well, and he keeps it concise so you don't have to filter through the content. The labs really compliment the teaching.
- Will say that the feedback from the labs hasn't been the greatest though. They let you know if what you've done is correct but don't assess your writing which would be helpful for the assignment.
- I think it depends on how lucky you get with the marker for the feedback. I went with the approach of write loads and see what they comment on and I ended up getting decent feedback (most of the time anyway). Content has also been very fun and if you like matrices and differentiation then it's nice to see its applications in the real world. Feel like we were left to ourselves a bit with learning matlab as the lectures focussed more on the theory, up but it's nice that there was a structure of theory followed by independent learning in the formatives. Be warned though, you think you're safe from AI and ML and then all of a sudden a guest lecturer comes in and makes you suffer. Hamid's slides are pretty nice but the guest lecturer's slides scream "graphic design is my passion".

06-35310	**Evolutionary Computation** **Evolutionary Computation (Extended)**	-	20

- The coursework assignments have been a good mix of interesting, challenging and relevant to the lecture content
- Dont know what the exams questions will look like

06-30214	**Human-Computer Interaction** **Human-Computer Interaction (Extended)**	20	-

- 'The easy option'
    - (as long as you put effort into the coursework, you can't just coast along like people seem to think)
- Get to pick your own groups in week five for the coursework after working with whoever you want for the first four weeks in formative assignments
- Russell is a good lecturer who puts a lot of effort into teaching to make the module engaging/enjoyable. Plenty of support and expectations for the final project were pretty well explained.
- A really nice option, shows you the "other" side of computer science, it's not only

06-30214	**Human-Computer Interaction** **Human-Computer Interaction (Extended)**	**20**	**-**

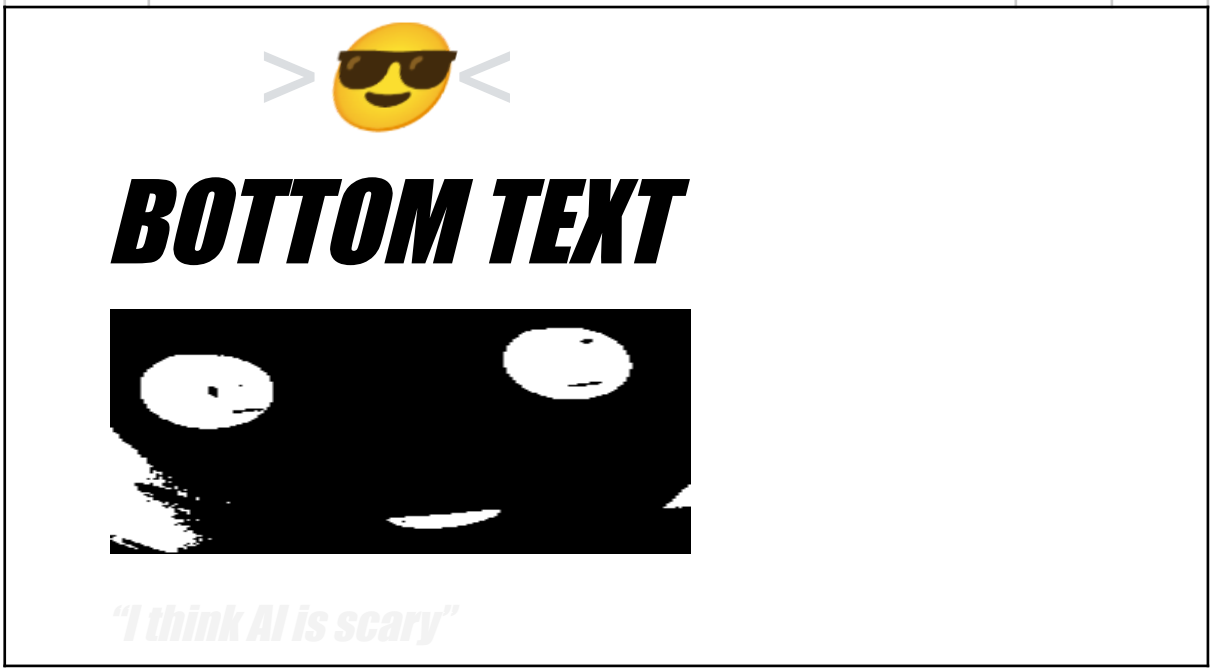
about computers you know

- Very relevant if you're planning on taking Intelligent Interactive Systems
- Definitely a module you can get away with not being so engaged with. Although the marking of the final coursework can be harsh, so don't be surprised. The more you put in, the more you get out of it.

06-37809	**Intelligent Interactive Systems** **Intelligent Interactive Systems (Extended)**	**-**	**20**

- A new module run by Andrew Howes, had some teething problems but I'd say it's well organised and taught at the moment.
- The content is a mix between some ML topics and psychological HCI stuff. Some really interesting content but also confusing at times.
- The continuous assessment is two 1000 word essays. Not a practical programming module if that's what you're looking for.
- Strong links with HCI and NLP.

06-30227	**Intelligent Robotics** **Intelligent Robotics (Extended)**	**20**	**-**



06-38965 06-38964	**Machine Learning and Intelligent Data Analysis** **Machine Learning and Intelligent Data Analysis (Extended)**	**20/20**	**-/-**
● Machine Learning ○ ● Intelligent Data Analysis ○			

06-29289	**Mobile & Computing** **Mobile & Ubiquitous Computing (Extended)**	**-**	**20**
● Learn what Ubiquitous means ● A lot of the content in this module seems sort of random. Topics between weeks don't lead into one another, each week feels like "Hey here's something else cool!!" ● So far we have done a small design for an IoT system (worth 20%), and a multiple choice quiz (worth 15%) ● Quiz was rather simple - could find answers for most of the questions online. ● The content is interesting but the lectures are very slow paced and disjointed. The assessments are quite unrelated and could probably be done without the **Ubiquitous** lectures at all. ● Not the most interesting module I've taken but not very hard. Labs involve a lot of copying and pasting (see last years feedback) and the lectures feel like a waste of time - always walk out wondering what I was supposed to have learned (particularly with Chris, less so the others). ● I find this module a strange one tbh. A lot of the lecture content seems irrelevant and kinda just showcases cool things that other people have created. ● The main thing that bugs me about this course is that the TAs give you very different feedback and advice from each other, making it difficult to know if you're doing an assessment to the best of your ability. ● I literally haven't been to a lecture since week one and I've been fine (i hope!!!! Take with a grain of salt). Take this module if you need to focus second semester on your project.			

06-37810	**Natural Language Processing** **Natural Language Processing (Extended)**	-	20

- Quite simplistic and then BAM here's a shit tonne of ML that you don't want to learn about
- Seems like the whole field is just fiddling around with the arguments to python packages? Like there's no objective science going on here?
- Something about fondue? idk I got lost halfway through

06-32167	**Neural Computation** **Neural Computation (Extended)**	20	-

- QIntroductory / tutorial file which teaches the basics of the modules, techniques etc
    - An exercise file where you implement the taught theory
    - The solutions for the exercise file with comments, these are also worked through in the labs
- The start of the module had quite a lot of overlap with Machine Learning and Intelligent Data Analysis, however if that module is being split this might not be the case next year.

06-30230	**Programming Language Principles, Design, and Implementation** **Programming Language Principles, Design, and Implementation (Extended)**	20	-

- lol
- This was interesting and difficult, toughest module I've ever taken
- if you really liked logic, make sure you actually know what lambda calculus is
- compiler side was easier and better and kinda more interesting than lambda calculus, but lambda calculus had more practice but more was assessed
- remembering the seven different LC systems is fucking annoying
    - Agreed, the subtle differences made it easy to go wrong.
    - Kind of disagree - agree it was hard at first and that there were subtle differences, but by the end of the module and spending some time on the practice questions it became very doable by the exam
- I wasn't a fan of first year logic, but I liked the proof system in this even though it was basically the same.
- Definitely a challenging module on the lambda calculus side, the compilers side (taught by Vincent) has a lot of content, but he's very clear what will actually be on

06-30230	**Programming Language Principles, Design, and Implementation** **Programming Language Principles, Design, and Implementation (Extended)**	**20**	**-**

the exam (not a lot compared to what he teaches), and the mock was very helpful for getting a picture of what his questions would be like.

- Vincent is super responsive on teams and email (I can't be the only one who's had responses at 2am before?)

06-35307	**Quantum Computing** **Quantum Computing (Extended)**	**-**	**20**

- I've heard they're not very organised tbh
- The teaching is genuinely awful, the content isn't really accessible and they spent like four weeks covering stuff even physics students never use
- You'll spend a lot of time reading different sources to try and understand what the question even wants. A lot of questions also involve long tedious calculations with matrices and complex numbers, which my calculator can't do at the same time 🙁
- The maths boot camp they gave us didn't really cover everything we needed, and it was just given to us with no proper direction.
- I'm enjoying the circuit bits, but manipulating one gate to work on another wire compared to what we've been given is complicated.
- Lectures seem all over the place - the provided textbook doesn't help whatsoever.
- Assignments are kinda poor; they're assuming a lot of knowledge and expecting a LOT in the time you're given tbh
- Most of the time, the effort/time you have to put into them are not even worth it - each assignment is worth only 5% of the whole mark but will take up your whole time.
- I feel like this could be a really good module as conceptually its all really interesting, but it seems like they have put too much content in as everything is too fast paced.
- After going over something briefly you're expected to know how to apply it all straight away and make logical leaps without any guidance. The assignments therefore take a lot of time just researching how to do things it feels like we weren't taught.
- Hope you like eigenvalues and googling stuff
- Some assignments contained content which the lecturers admitted to not being taught to us, have fun :D
- There are barely any examples in the lecture materials, so good luck doing the assignments (also RIP us in the upcoming exam)

06-30231	**Security of Real-World Systems** **Security of Real-World Systems (Extended)**	**20**	**-**

- Banger of a module
    - Yeah properly organised too except no mock exam which was annoying
- Split 50-50 between Tom Chothia (good lecturer) and David Oswald (also good lecturer)
    - Tom does software stuff and binary exploits and protocols and game hacking!
    - David does hardware stuff like how you can get into a car or get secret info from low-level devices
- The 'just make a game hack lol' assignment is PAIN
    - The other two assignments are chill though, relevant to the module and a good chance to try out the techniques for yourself - actual programming!
    - Honestly if you have a good group this assignment is great fun
    - If you can come up with a cool idea that also is reasonable for the time frame (and are working with friends) then this might be the most fun you can have with an assignment in your degree
- Be prepared for the exam - don't let assignments fool you into thinking you know the material very well.
- Brilliant module, lots of really interesting attacks and demos throughout
- You can tell how passionate Tom and David are and it really makes the lectures and content super enjoyable. There's a good mix of theory and then using that in practice which keeps things fresh too. Probably my favourite module this year.
- If you enjoyed Security and Networks and want to learn more, I would pick this module. Tom and David are experts in their fields and are also good lecturers to boot. I would probably say this is the most interesting content I've covered in my degree
    - (hello i am another person replying to this point) Small caveat to this point though, network security is rarely (if at all) mentioned. The focus is on lower level security e.g. buffer overflows. I didn't realise this until week 1 and i was very worried because i found that stuff quite hard and boring, but then when I learnt about it properly in this module, I understood it really well, enjoyed it, and appreciated it. Thought it was super interesting!
- If they teach it the same way as they did for us, there will be pre recorded videos from covid era which cover the same content, useful for those who prefer it as opposed to going into lectures (but the in person lectures are also useful and worth going to)
- This module is very interesting, but a lot harder than I was expecting. I also remember a lot of people coming out of the exam feeling very unsure on what the outcome would be. Be prepared to put A LOT of work in to do well.
- I wish this module was a 50/50 split because the amount of work we did for the coursework didn't feel worth the 20% overall.

06-30231	**Security of Real-World Systems** **Security of Real-World Systems (Extended)**	**20**	**-**

- If you want to spend a night in the labs until 5am hacking CS:GO then this is the module for you!
- Really nice module, the content is engaging, the only drawback is the exam which is quite hard and requires a creative mind as in any other security exam (writing as a Cyber Sec MSc student, I actually found the exam of this module more difficult than the core security module exams I have in the Master's degree)

06-34240	**Secure Software and Hardware Systems**	**-**	**20**

- This module is only available for 4th year masters
- David Oswald, one of the lecturers for this module, says that it IS different to Security of Real-World Systems, but the last 2-ish weeks are about software side channels, which is the same material as the software side channels material from SoRWS, but that's the only overlap between them. The rest of the module seems to be about practical defences against the kind of attacks from SoRWS I think?
- Above comment isn't totally correct, **LOTS** of crossover with SoRWS.
- Ian's half is just him telling you why C is terrible, teaching basic security (buffer overflows, stack canaries etc) and telling you fun security related stories
- Get great quotes like "I hope this isn't classified" and "when Richard Stallman was staying at my house"
- You get to write crypto for the Pi Pico which is fun
- 50% coursework

06-30208	**Teaching Computer Science in Schools** **Teaching Computer Science in Schools (Extended)**	**20**

- Really cool module and something completely different!
- WARNING: Lectures for this are in first term but teaching is in second term so is potentially quite a lot of workload. Also going into school at like 8:30am once a week is tiring
- It's basically up to your school what they want you to do
    - Normally: observing for a week or two > helping in lessons > running a starter/plenary > running most of a lesson > teaching a whole lesson by the end
- Can express preference for primary or secondary but 90% of the schools are secondaries

Further Advice

For Everyone

- Choose your module workload carefully
    - Having a top loaded first term can be hell but allows you time to work hard on your FYP in second term, which can be a blessing when you inevitably realise how little progress you've actually made
    - Keep in mind fully-assessed CA modules vs ones with exams as well
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For Maths and Computer Science Students

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For Degree Apprentice Students

- DA requirements can be found here.
- You need to pick a speciality and fulfil all the skills and technical knowledge for that speciality **as part of your project only**.
- This matters for the inspection, and for the EPA mostly.
    - At the inspection, you'll need to provide "some" justification that your project will meet each of these requirements.
    - At the EPA, you'll need to make and deliver a presentation justifying how you met the requirements.
- Your project idea should be "something your company could feasibly be working on or use in some way" - the scope is pretty broad as long as you can make a case for it.
- A lot of the supervisors will have absolutely no idea about these requirements apart from a select few involved in the degree apprenticeship itself.
- Side note: don't book any holidays straight after Summer exams. EPAs will likely be then, and it's unlikely the University will move them like they did this year.